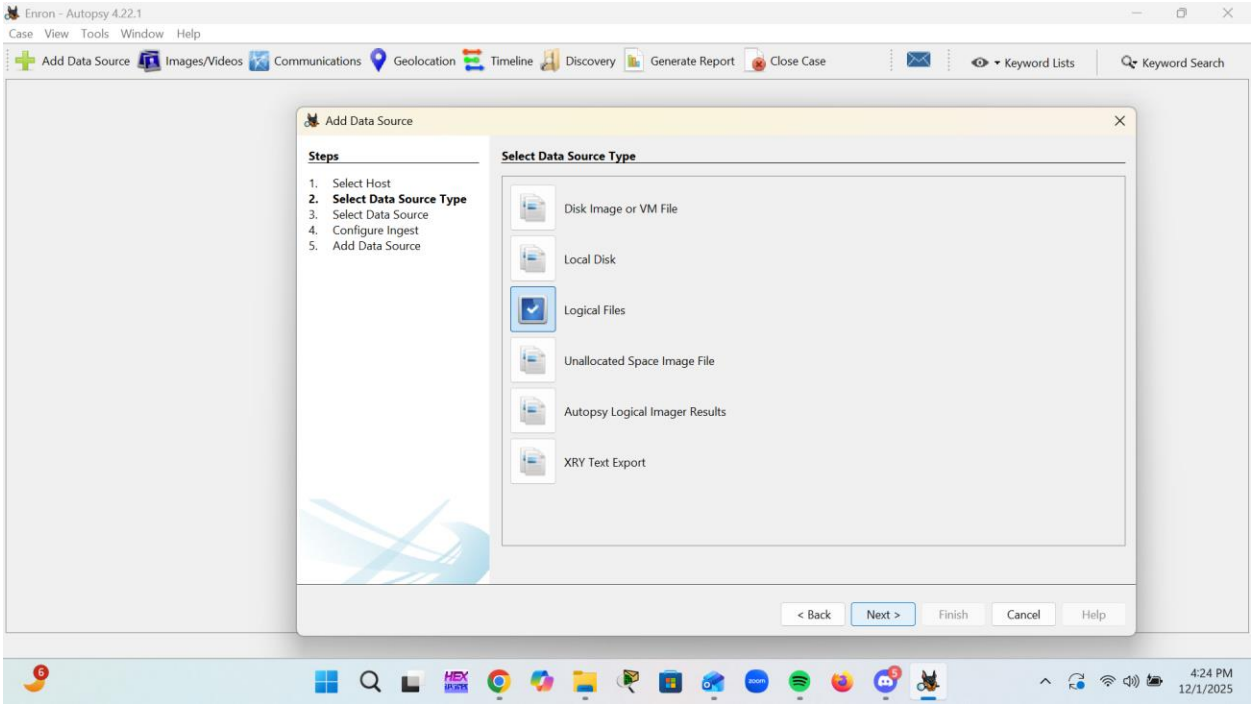
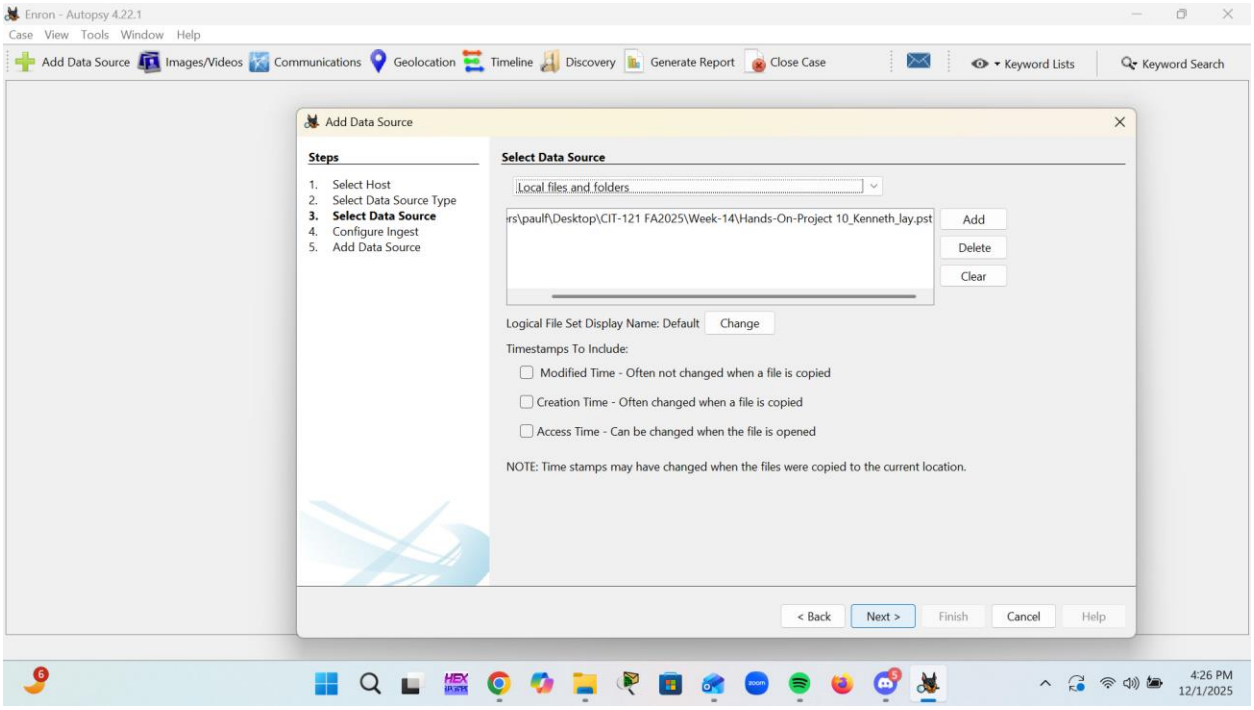

Enron - Autopsy 4.22.1
Case View Tools Window Help
Add Data Source
Images/Videos
Communications
Geolocation
Timeline
Discovery
Generate Report
Close Case
Keyword Lists
Keyword Search
Add Data Source
Steps
1. Select Host
2. Select Data Source Type
3. Select Data Source
4. Configure Ingest
5. Add Data Source
Select Data Source Type
Disk Image or VM File
Local Disk
Logical Files
Unallocated Space Image File
Autopsy Logical Imager Results
XRY Text Export
< Back
Next >
Finish
Cancel
Help
4:24 PM
12/1/2025


Enron - Autopsy 4.22.1
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Add Data Source
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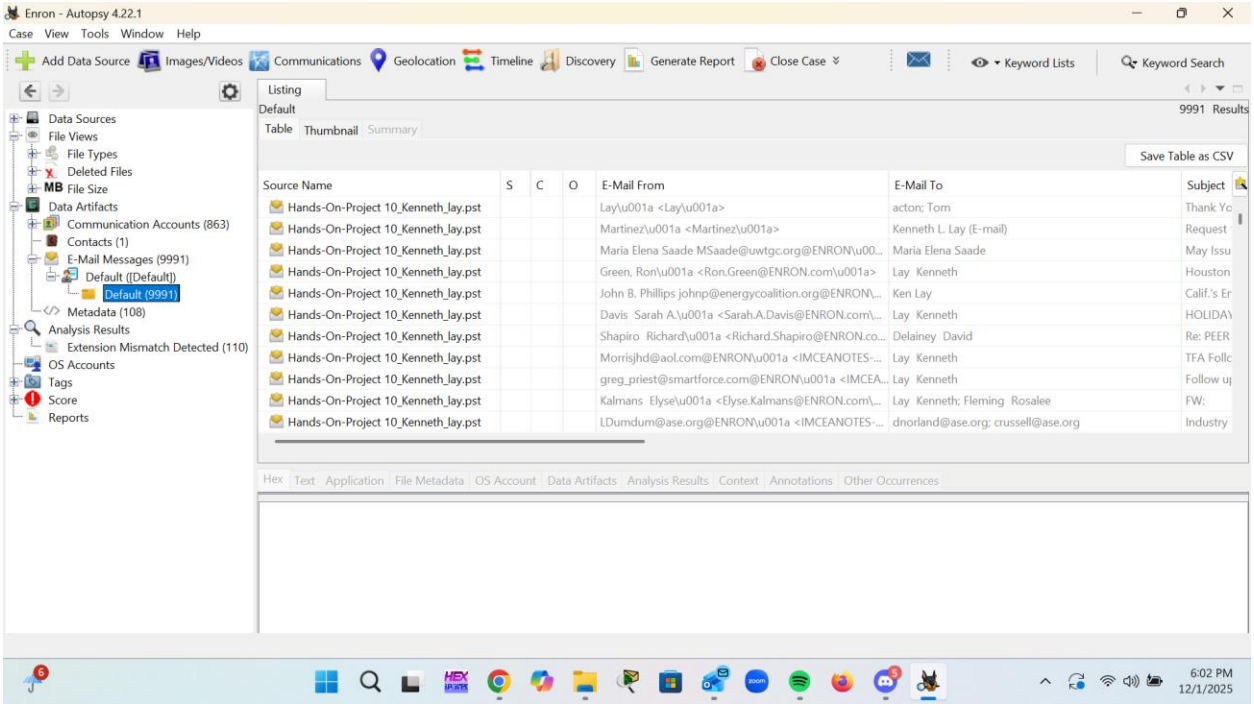
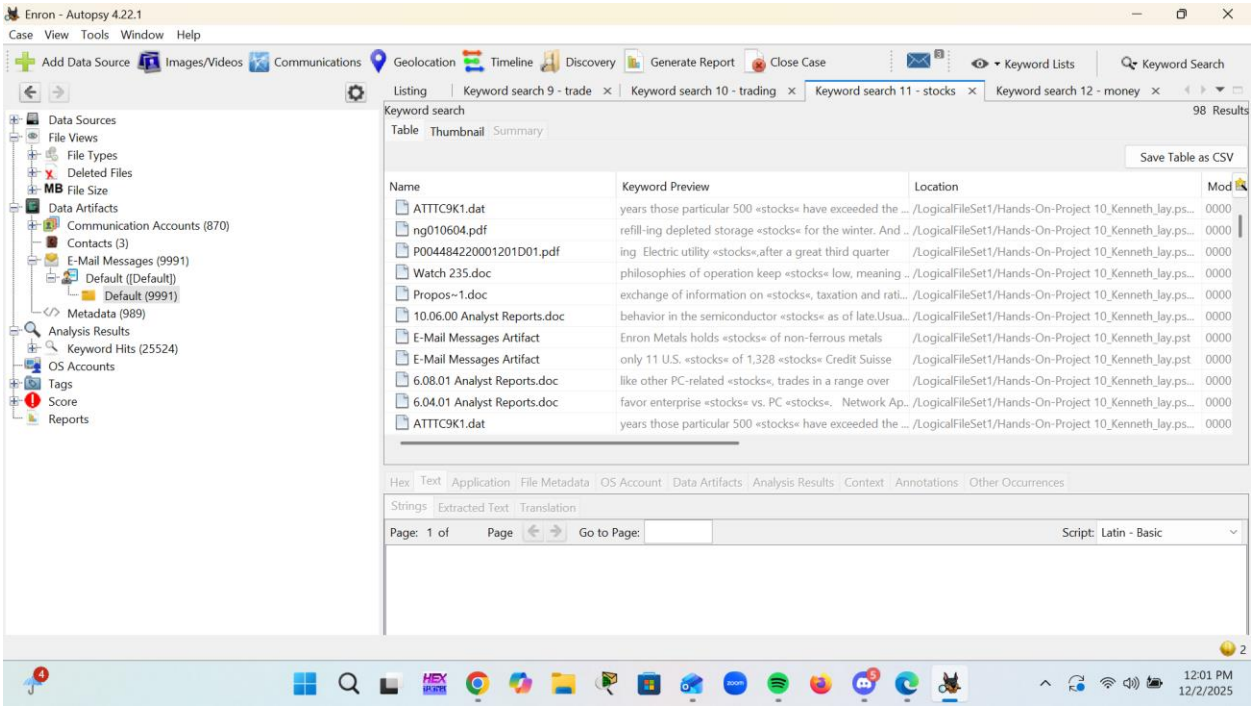
Add Data Source
Steps
1. Select Host
2. Select Data Source Type
3. Select Data Source
4. Configure Ingest
5. Add Data Source
Select Data Source
Local files and folders
rs\paulf\Desktop\CIT-121 FA2025\Week-14\Hands-On-Project 10_Kenneth_lay.pst
Add
Delete
Clear
Logical File Set Display Name: Default
Change
Timestamps To Include:
Modified Time - Often not changed when a file is copied
Creation Time - Often changed when a file is copied
Access Time - Can be changed when the file is opened
NOTE: Time stamps may have changed when the files were copied to the current location.
< Back
Next >
Finish
Cancel
Help
4:26 PM
12/1/2025





While using Autopsy to examine the e-mails connected to Kenneth Lay, one message that stood out to me came from a person named KC Hatcher. In this e-mail, the writer urged Ken Lay to donate the money he made from selling Enron stock before the company collapsed. The e-mail specifically mentions that Lay made over $100 million while regular employees lost their retirement savings and many consumers struggled during the California energy crisis. The writer also pointed out that, according to news at the time, Lay was encouraging employees to keep

investing in Enron stock while he was selling his own shares. This e-mail helped me see how people outside the company viewed Lay's actions and how strongly they felt about the financial harm that Enron caused to employees and consumers. Another example was an e-mail from an employee (Stephen.Perich@ENRON.com) who wrote directly to Lay expressing concern about falling morale and the stress people were experiencing. These messages helped me see how people inside the company were growing worried while Lay was still encouraging confidence and trying to calm everyone down. Other useful search keywords I would include are: morale, whistleblower, stress, bankrupty, and debt.

Looking at these e-mails together, the evidence suggests that Kenneth Lay played a role in shaping the narrative that Enron was still stable, even though he likely knew the situation was much worse. The e-mails may not show technical accounting decisions, but they do reveal how he communicated in a way that didn't match the company's true condition. Using Autopsy made the process easier because I could filter messages by keywords, sender, and date ranges. This helped me quickly find conversations that related to the scandal. Autopsy is a helpful tool for analyzing e-mails because it organizes everything in one place, but it still requires good search terms and some understanding of the case to get meaningful results. Overall, using Autopsy gave me a clearer picture of how internal communication played a role in understanding Kenneth Lay's involvement in the Enron case.